FOUNDERS HOUSE · MASTERCLASS 1 · 20 NOVEMBER · FIRST THOUGHTS

Know Enough.

Bookkeeper, lawyer or ops hire: what does your business need now, and next?

David, this is where I've landed for November. It's different from the course but complements it. I'd love your thoughts before I finalise it.

THE IDEA

Founders don’t need to become the operations person. They need to know enough to know when to bring someone in, who, and what to ask.

Most founders think operations means process. Process is one part of it. I'll show them the whole picture, then give them two tests to run on their own business:

NOW

The house isn’t on fire.

I understand what’s happening, and the company can exist.

NEXT

If I stepped away, what breaks?

And where would we still need a person’s judgement?

Once a business has paying clients and comfortable runway, it needs a written plan, and every part of the business has to answer to it. That's my view, and two well-known Harvard Business Review models of how businesses grow back it: Churchill and Lewis, and Greiner.

WHAT I'LL COVER · 60 MINUTES

0–7	What operations actually is: eight parts, not just process
7–13	The Now and Next tests, and the point where a business needs a plan
13–37	People, finance and legal, followed through one fictional company: what good enough looks like, what changes at Next, and who could help, starting with the smallest step
37–39	“Can’t I just use AI?”
39–50	How to brief a specialist precisely, with a live rewrite
50–60	This week’s action, and questions

WHAT FOUNDERS LEAVE WITH

The Know Enough Map scored for their own business, one red area picked, and a four-part brief ready to send that week. It isn't advice: it shows them how to ask, not when they need a professional.

WHERE I’D LOVE YOUR THOUGHTS

1. Does the question land with your members?
2. I’ve kept it to the business rather than founder behaviour, which is your ground. Does the Now-to-Next pivot sit comfortably alongside your work?
3. One slide suggests that once founders can afford it, they get a neutral operator to look at the whole business. Is that OK in your group, or does it read as a pitch?
4. Could we send members the map 48 hours ahead, so they arrive already scored?
5. I’d like to share the idea on my website and LinkedIn, and keep developing the material as a series. How would you like Founders House credited?